Vaal Mediation

FREE PRINTABLE · A4 · ONE MONTH PER PAGE

2027 Family Planner

A calm, practical way to keep the family's month in view, whether everyone lives under one roof or care is shared between two households. Print it, pin it up, or keep a copy in each home.

How to use it

1. **Print** on plain A4 paper, landscape, at actual size (100%).
2. **Choose a colour** for each household and child, colour the small squares in the key on each month and write the names. Use the same pens or highlighters all year.
3. **Mark whose care** each day is with the A / B circles in each date box. On handover days, write ⇄ and the time.
4. **Add school terms and holidays** from your school's own calendar. Schools differ, so we've left them blank. Add any public holidays you need from an official source.
5. **Use the side column** for handovers, school deadlines, appointments, activities and shared costs.
6. **Note every agreed change** and the date it was confirmed in writing.

Your colour key

☐ Household A ☐ Household B ☐ Child 1 ☐ Child 2

☐ Shared

Labels are neutral on purpose (Household A / B, Child 1 / 2), so the planner works for any family. Write in the names that suit yours.

Before each month, check

- **Handovers:** who collects, from where, at what time, and what travels with the child (school bag, homework, sports kit, medication).
- **Activities:** who drives to and from each practice, lesson or match.
- **School:** forms, fees, projects, outings and meetings, with their due dates.
- **Appointments:** who books, who attends, and what to bring, such as a medical aid card or clinic card.
- **Shared costs:** what's due, how much, who pays which part (as you've already agreed), and when it was paid.
- **Routines:** bedtime, homework time, screen time and medication, so the child's week feels familiar in both homes.

HANDOVER BAG CHECKLIST

☐ School bag & homework ☐ Uniform & sports kit

☐ Medication & instructions ☐ Chargers & devices

☐ Comfort item ☐ Note for the other home

Agreeing schedule changes calmly

1. **Ask early.** Raise a change as soon as you know about it, so there's time to plan.
2. **Be specific.** Give the date, times, place and who collects, and offer a swap if that's fair.
3. **Keep it practical.** One topic per message, about arrangements and the child's routine.
4. **Allow time to reply.** Agree a reasonable reply window, and a separate way to flag a real emergency.
5. **Confirm in writing.** Once you've agreed, send a short "Confirming…" message and note it here.
6. **If you're stuck,** keep to the existing arrangement for now, and consider a structured conversation with a neutral mediator.

MESSAGE TEMPLATES

"Hi, could we change [date]? I'd suggest [new day and time], with [who] collecting from [place]. In return I can [offer]. Could you let me know by [day]? Thanks."

"Confirming what we agreed: on [date], [who] will collect [child] from [place] at [time]. Thanks."

> This planner is a family organiser only. It is not a parenting plan, court order or legal agreement, and it doesn't change any existing agreement or order. Mediation is not legal advice; each person may wish to consult their own attorney.

Need help agreeing a schedule? Talk to a mediator.

Vaal Mediation offers family mediation in the Vaal and online, including parenting plans and co-parenting schedules. The first 30-minute mediation consultation is free.

vaalmediation.co.za · hello@vaalmediation.co.za

VAAL MEDIATION · FAMILY PLANNER

January 2027

COLOUR KEY

- ☐ Household A — name
- ☐ Household B — name
- ☐ Child 1 — name
- ☐ Child 2 — name
- ☐ Shared — name

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
				1 A○ B○	2 A○ B○	3 A○ B○
4 A○ B○	5 A○ B○	6 A○ B○	7 A○ B○	8 A○ B○	9 A○ B○	10 A○ B○
11 A○ B○	12 A○ B○	13 A○ B○	14 A○ B○	15 A○ B○	16 A○ B○	17 A○ B○
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Handovers

who · where · when · what travels

School events & deadlines

forms · fees · outings

School holidays (copy from your school):

Appointments

who takes · what to bring

Activities & transport

who drives there · who collects

Shared costs due

Item	Amount	Due	Paid ✓

Changes agreed

confirmed in writing on

Child's routines to keep

bedtime · homework · meds

VAAL MEDIATION · FAMILY PLANNER

February 2027

COLOUR KEY

- ☐ Household A — name
- ☐ Household B — name
- ☐ Child 1 — name
- ☐ Child 2 — name
- ☐ Shared — name

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
1 A○ B○	2 A○ B○	3 A○ B○	4 A○ B○	5 A○ B○	6 A○ B○	7 A○ B○
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March 2027

COLOUR KEY

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- ☐ Household B — name
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MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
1 A○ B○	2 A○ B○	3 A○ B○	4 A○ B○	5 A○ B○	6 A○ B○	7 A○ B○
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April 2027

COLOUR KEY

- ☐ Household A — name
- ☐ Household B — name
- ☐ Child 1 — name
- ☐ Child 2 — name
- ☐ Shared — name

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
			1 A○ B○	2 A○ B○	3 A○ B○	4 A○ B○
5 A○ B○	6 A○ B○	7 A○ B○	8 A○ B○	9 A○ B○	10 A○ B○	11 A○ B○
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May 2027

COLOUR KEY

- ☐ Household A — name
- ☐ Household B — name
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MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
					1 A○ B○	2 A○ B○
3 A○ B○	4 A○ B○	5 A○ B○	6 A○ B○	7 A○ B○	8 A○ B○	9 A○ B○
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June 2027

COLOUR KEY

- ☐ Household A — name
- ☐ Household B — name
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MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
	1 A○ B○	2 A○ B○	3 A○ B○	4 A○ B○	5 A○ B○	6 A○ B○
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July 2027

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- ☐ Household B — name
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MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
			1 A○ B○	2 A○ B○	3 A○ B○	4 A○ B○
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October 2027

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December 2027

COLOUR KEY

- ☐ Household A — name
- ☐ Household B — name
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MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
		1 A○ B○	2 A○ B○	3 A○ B○	4 A○ B○	5 A○ B○
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